



# Indian peafowl

*Pavo cristatus*

Peafowl have been collected for ornamental purposes for more than 3,000 years. This, combined with artificial introductions into other parts of the world, has made the peacock's display familiar to millions who have never visited its Asian homeland. Here, peafowl live in open or riverside woodland and close to human habitation, in orchards and cultivated land. Drawing attention with their loud, off-key calls, they may be seen flying into trees at dusk to find a safe roost for the night.

## Ground nesters

By day, peafowl forage on the ground. Females visit several displaying males at a lek before choosing the one with most eyespots on its tail. Males play no part in nesting or caring for the young. The nests are made on the ground in dense vegetation. Up to six eggs hatch after four weeks, and the chicks quickly learn to find food for themselves.

**Peacock blue** is one of the **most intense blues** in the world

- ↔ 6–8 ft (1.8–2.4 m)
- ⚖ 9–13 lb (4–6 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍽 Seeds, fruit, plants, insects
- 🏠



S. Asia

## ▷ IRIDESCENT TRAIN

The peacock's "tail" is actually a train of elongated feathers supported by a short, stiff tail beneath.

